

CRIM 415: Forensic Science and Criminal Jurisprudence

Term: Fall 2026 | Instructor: Dr. Henry Lee (hlee@law.criminology.edu)

Course Description & Overview:

Examination of physical and biological trace evidence, forensic toxicology, ballistic mechanics, and evidentiary admissibility standards.

COURSE ASSIGNMENTS & WEIGHT DISTRIBUTION

Assignment Description	Weight	Due Module	Deliverable Format
Forensic Evidence Chain of Custody Report	25%	Week 04	Evidence Locker Audit
Mock Trial Expert Witness Testimony	35%	Week 09	Oral Direct & Cross-Examination
Comprehensive Criminal Law Exam	30%	Week 12	Proctored Exam
Crime Scene Simulation Assessment	10%	Week 06	Field Processing Assessment

WEEKLY TERM SCHEDULE & READING REQUIREMENTS

Timeline	Technical Topic Focus	Assigned Readings & Docs
Week 01	Module 01: Physical Evidence & Locard Principle	Saferstein (Ch. 1–2)
Week 02	Module 02: Crime Scene Preservation & Documentation	FBI Crime Scene Documentation
Week 03	Module 03: Fingerprint Ridgeology & AFIS Systems	Champod et al. (Ch. 3–5)
Week 04	Module 04: Forensic Serology & DNA Profiling (STR)	Butler (Ch. 2–4)
Week 05	Module 05: Forensic Ballistics & Toolmarks	Heard (Ch. 6 & 7)
Week 06	Module 06: Forensic Toxicology & Spectrometry	Moffat et al. (Ch. 8)
Week 07	Module 07: Digital Forensics & Mobile Extraction	NIST SP 800-72 Guidelines
Week 08	Module 08: Bloodstain Pattern Analysis (BPA)	Bevel & Gardner (Ch. 3–5)
Week 09	Module 09: Expert Witness Testimony & Daubert Standard	Federal Rules of Evidence 702
Week 10	Module 10: Forensic Pathology & Postmortem Interval	DiMaio (Ch. 2)
Week 11	Module 11: Miscarriages of Justice & Faulty Forensics	Garrett & Neufeld (2009)
Week 12	Module 12: Review and Jurisprudence Examination	Forensic Standards Review